LEX-CNF · PRÁCTICA 02

Confusables y palabras sueltas de nivel C2

Hoja 02 · Palabras de la lista de entrada en su grupo

Part 1: 8 ítems (1–8) · Part 4: 6 ítems (25–30) · 20 puntos · tiempo orientativo: 25 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

Formato real del examen. En esta hoja, las cuatro opciones de cada hueco de la Part 1 son, casi siempre, un grupo de confusables de la teoría; en el examen se mezclan con collocations, idioms y phrasal verbs.

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

For questions 1–8, read the text below and decide which answer (A, B, C or D) best fits each gap. There is an example at the beginning (0). Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Example:

0	**A** insuperable	**B** invincible	**C** inexorable	**D** irresistible

The answer is **D** (irresistible).

Six weeks of silence

Last winter I spent six weeks at a writers' retreat in a remote farmhouse in the Highlands. For the first few days I had to fight an almost **(0)** _____ urge to check my phone, which, in any case, had no signal. After that, the silence became a pleasure.

The rules were simple. A cook and a housekeeper looked after us, and tasks that most writers regard as pure **(1)** _____ – checking footnotes, chasing permissions, answering readers' letters – were strictly forbidden. We wrote in our rooms until one o'clock and then **(2)** _____ over lunch in the kitchen, reluctant to return to our desks.

Our host, a retired actor, had a truly **(3)** _____ knack for remembering every guest's name and favourite book, and whenever there was a **(4)** _____ in the conversation at dinner, he would fill it with an anecdote about some long-forgotten production.

Not everything went smoothly. A momentary **(5)** _____ in the farmhouse's ancient computer wiped two of my chapters, and the library, crammed with damp old books, had a smell so **(6)** _____ that no amount of airing could shift it. On my last evening, reading a chapter aloud, I called my heroine by the name of my ex-wife – a **(7)** _____ of the tongue that caused great amusement. Later, lying awake, I listened to the **(8)** _____ roar of the wind beyond the thick stone walls and wished I could stay another month.

1	**A** chore	**B** drudgery	**C** errand	**D** grind
2	**A** prowled	**B** lurked	**C** lingered	**D** sauntered
3	**A** uncanny	**B** eerie	**C** sinister	**D** lurid
4	**A** reprieve	**B** lull	**C** respite	**D** truce
5	**A** hitch	**B** snag	**C** flaw	**D** glitch
6	**A** stuffy	**B** airless	**C** musty	**D** muggy
7	**A** howler	**B** blunder	**C** gaffe	**D** slip
8	**A** muffled	**B** stifled	**C** smothered	**D** quelled

Part 4 · Key word transformations

For questions 25–30, complete the second sentence so that it has a similar meaning to the first sentence, using the word given. **Do not change the word given.** You must use between **three** and **eight** words, including the word given. Here is an example (0).

Example:

0 He said that he had not taken the money.

DENIED

He denied having taken the money.

The gap can be filled by the words 'denied having taken', so you write:

0 DENIED HAVING TAKEN

Write only the missing words IN CAPITAL LETTERS.

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25 Officially, the visit was a courtesy call, but in reality she used it to negotiate a deal.

OSTENSIBLY

She used _____ to negotiate a deal.

26 I felt deeply embarrassed when I realised I had been calling him by the wrong name all evening.

MORTIFIED

I _____ I had been calling him by the wrong name all evening.

27 While he was working abroad, he missed his family terribly.

PINED

Throughout his time _____ his family.

28 His teachers never recognised his talent because he blossomed so late.

DEVELOPER

Because he _____, his teachers never recognised his talent.

29 It took him years to get rid of the sloppy technique he had picked up as a self-taught guitarist.

UNLEARN

It was years _____ the sloppy technique he had picked up as a self-taught guitarist.

30 Many villagers are still bitter that the council closed the library.

RANKLES

It still _____ the council closed the library.

Hoja de respuestas · Part 1

Escribe la letra elegida (A, B, C o D). Al corregir, marca 1 punto por acierto; una respuesta doble vale 0.

Nº	Respuesta (A–D)	Punto
1		/ 1
2		/ 1
3		/ 1
4		/ 1
5		/ 1
6		/ 1
7		/ 1
8		/ 1
Total		**/ 8**

Hoja de respuestas · Part 4

Nº	Respuesta (en mayúsculas)	Puntos
25		/ 2
26		/ 2
27		/ 2
28		/ 2
29		/ 2
30		/ 2
	Total	/ 12
Total de la hoja		**/ 20**

SOLUCIONES

Part 1 · Multiple-choice cloze

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución explica por qué es correcta la clave y por qué falla cada distractor, y remite al apartado de LEX-CNF_Teoria_v1 (o de la teoría donde está explicado).

Nº	Clave	Grupo o expresión	Teoría
1	B · drudgery	chore / drudgery / toil / grind	§8.1
2	C · lingered	linger / loiter / lurk / saunter	§7.2
3	A · uncanny	eerie / uncanny / sinister / lurid	§4.5
4	B · lull	lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus	§6.2
5	D · glitch	glitch / hitch / snag / flaw	§8.2
6	C · musty	stuffy / airless / musty / stale	§7.3
7	D · slip	howler / blunder / gaffe / slip	§8.3
8	A · muffled	muffle / stifle / smother / quell	§9.3

1 · B drudgery

Por qué: pure drudgery: trabajo monótono y pesado. Es incontable, así que va sin artículo tras regard as pure, y la lista (notas, permisos, cartas) describe justo esa monotonía.

A chore: chore es contable: haría falta a chore, no *pure chore.

C errand: errand es un recado; además es contable, así que tampoco admite *pure errand.

D grind: grind es la rutina agotadora y suele ir con artículo (the daily grind, a long grind); *pure grind no es la combinación.

Teoría: §8.1 chore / drudgery / toil / grind

2 · C lingered

Por qué: linger over a meal: alargar la comida, resistirse a irse. Reluctant to return to our desks lo confirma.

A prowled: prowl es merodear al acecho, como un animal o un ladrón; no se combina con over lunch.

B lurked: lurk es acechar o esconderse con mala intención.

D sauntered: saunter es caminar con aire despreocupado (§7.1); no se saunter over lunch.

Teoría: §7.2 linger / loiter / dawdle / lurk

3 · A uncanny

Por qué: an uncanny knack for: una habilidad asombrosa, casi inexplicable. Uncanny va con ability, knack o resemblance y transmite asombro, no miedo.

B eerie: eerie crea una atmósfera inquietante (un silencio, una luz); no va con knack.

C sinister: sinister sugiere maldad; no hay nada malo en recordar nombres.

D lurid: lurid es escabroso o de colores chillones (§5.3); no describe una habilidad.

Teoría: §4.5 eerie / uncanny / sinister / spooky

4 • B lull

Por qué: a lull in the conversation: un silencio pasajero en algo activo. Lull lleva in.

A reprieve: reprieve es un indulto o la salvación in extremis de algo amenazado.

C respite: respite es un alivio de algo desagradable y va con from (a respite from the heat).

D truce: truce es una tregua entre dos partes enfrentadas; *a truce in the conversation no existe.

Teoría: §6.2 lull / respite / reprieve / hiatus

5 • D glitch

Por qué: glitch: fallo técnico menor y pasajero (informática, maquinaria). Momentary y computer lo piden.

A hitch: hitch es un contratiempo que retrasa un proceso (without a hitch), no el fallo de una máquina que borra archivos.

B snag: snag es una pega que surge (the snag is that).

C flaw: flaw es un defecto intrínseco y permanente; no puede ser momentary.

Teoría: §8.2 glitch / hitch / snag / flaw

6 • C musty

Por qué: musty: con olor a humedad y a cerrado, típico de los libros viejos. Damp old books lo explica, y no amount of airing could shift it descarta un simple problema de ventilación.

A stuffy: stuffy describe una habitación cargada, mal ventilada, no un olor; y se arregla aireándola: justo lo que el texto dice que no funcionó.

B airless: airless es «sin ventilación»; tampoco resiste que se ventile y no describe un olor.

D muggy: muggy describe el tiempo bochornoso y húmedo; no se dice de un olor.

Teoría: §7.3 stuffy / airless / musty / stale

7 • D slip

Por qué: a slip of the tongue: un lapsus al hablar. Es la combinación fija de slip.

A howler: howler es un error garrafal y ridículo, sobre todo por escrito; no forma *a howler of the tongue.

B blunder: blunder es un error grave con consecuencias; tampoco va con of the tongue.

C gaffe: gaffe es una metedura de pata social, pero no forma *a gaffe of the tongue.

Teoría: §8.3 howler / blunder / gaffe / slip

8 • A muffled

Por qué: muffled: amortiguado. Un sonido que llega tapado, aquí por los muros gruesos, es muffled.

B stifled: stifled se dice de lo que uno mismo reprime (un grito, un bostezo), no de un sonido que atraviesa una pared.

C smothered: smothered es sofocado o asfixiado (el fuego; alguien agobiado de afecto); no describe el sonido del viento.

D quelled: quelled es sofocado por la fuerza (disturbios, una rebelión).

Teoría: §9.3 muffle / stifle / smother / quell

Part 4 · Key word transformations

Corrige cada ítem por mitades: 1 punto por cada mitad correcta y bien escrita. Se acepta cualquiera de las variantes indicadas; las respuestas fuera de 3–8 palabras o con la palabra clave cambiada valen 0.

25 WHAT WAS OSTENSIBLY A COURTESY CALL (6 palabras)

También vale: WHAT (WAS OSTENSIBLY / OSTENSIBLY WAS) [JUST / ONLY] A COURTESY (CALL / VISIT) (6–7) · **WHAT WAS OSTENSIBLY (MEANT / INTENDED) AS A COURTESY (CALL / VISIT)** (8) · **WHAT HAD OSTENSIBLY BEEN A COURTESY (CALL / VISIT)** (7) · **THE VISIT, [WHICH WAS] OSTENSIBLY A COURTESY CALL,** (6–8) · **THE VISIT, OSTENSIBLY MADE AS A COURTESY CALL,** (8) · **A VISIT (THAT / WHICH) WAS OSTENSIBLY A COURTESY CALL** (8)

Mitades: what was | ostensibly a courtesy call

Por qué: Ostensibly: en apariencia, oficialmente, cuando la razón declarada oculta otra; recoge officially … but in reality. Como el hueco no tiene antecedente, hace falta el relativo nominal what: she used what was ostensibly a courtesy call to negotiate a deal.

No puntúa: *WHICH WAS OSTENSIBLY A COURTESY CALL (sin antecedente, el relativo es what, no which); *WHAT WAS APPARENTLY A COURTESY CALL (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; apparently transmite lo que se ha oído, no la razón oficial).

Teoría: §5.4 ostensibly / apparently / supposedly / allegedly

26 WAS MORTIFIED TO REALISE THAT (5 palabras)

También vale: (WAS / FELT) [ABSOLUTELY / UTTERLY / DEEPLY] MORTIFIED (TO REALISE / TO REALIZE / TO DISCOVER / TO FIND / WHEN I REALISED / WHEN I REALIZED / WHEN I DISCOVERED / WHEN I FOUND / ON REALISING / ON REALIZING / UPON REALISING / ON DISCOVERING / ON FINDING / AS I REALISED) [THAT] (4–7) · **(WAS / FELT) MORTIFIED WHEN IT DAWNED ON ME [THAT]** (7–8)

Mitades: was mortified | to realise (that)

Por qué: Mortified: muerto de vergüenza, el grado extremo de embarrassed (recoge deeply). Tras él va to + infinitivo, when + oración u on + -ing.

No puntúa: *WAS MORTIFIED REALISING THAT (tras mortified no va -ing directamente: to realise, on realising); *WAS MORTIFYING TO REALISE THAT (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0).

Teoría: §4.1 embarrassed / ashamed / mortified / humiliated

27 WORKING ABROAD, HE PINED FOR (5 palabras)

También vale: [SPENT] WORKING (ABROAD, / OVERSEAS,) HE PINED [TERRIBLY / DESPERATELY / DREADFULLY] FOR (5–7) · **WORKING IN (ANOTHER / A FOREIGN) COUNTRY, HE PINED FOR** (7–8)

Mitades: working abroad, he | pined for

Por qué: Pine for sb / sth: añorar sufriendo por una ausencia, justo lo que expresa missed … terribly; por eso el intensificador puede ir o no (was pining no vale: cambia la palabra clave). Throughout his time pide una frase sin verbo conjugado (working abroad: sin working se pierde información) y la oración principal con su sujeto.

No puntúa: *WORKING ABROAD, HE PINED (falta for: pine lo exige); *WORKING ABROAD, HE PINED AWAY FOR (pine away es consumirse de pena hasta enfermar: exagera).

Teoría: §4.3 long for / yearn for / pine for / crave

28 WAS SUCH A LATE DEVELOPER (5 palabras)

También vale: (WAS / HAD BEEN) SUCH A LATE DEVELOPER (5–6) · **WAS SO LATE A DEVELOPER** (5) · **WAS (A VERY / AN EXTREMELY / AN EXCEPTIONALLY / SUCH AN EXCEPTIONALLY) LATE DEVELOPER** (5–6)

Mitades: was such a | late developer

Por qué: A late developer: alguien que madura o destaca tarde (también late bloomer). So late con verbo pasa a such a late developer con sustantivo; también vale so late a developer, más formal.

No puntúa: *WAS A LATE DEVELOPER (pierde la intensidad de so: falta una mitad); *WAS SO LATE DEVELOPER (con sustantivo, such a o so late a).

Teoría: §14 Personas y carácter

29 BEFORE HE COULD UNLEARN (4 palabras)

También vale: BEFORE HE (COULD / MANAGED TO) [FINALLY / FULLY / COMPLETELY] UNLEARN (4–6) · **BEFORE HE FINALLY (COULD / MANAGED TO) UNLEARN** (5–6) · **BEFORE HE WAS [FINALLY / FULLY] ABLE TO UNLEARN** (6–7) · **BEFORE HE WAS ABLE TO (FINALLY / FULLY / COMPLETELY) UNLEARN** (7) · **BEFORE HE HAD MANAGED TO UNLEARN** (6) · **BEFORE HE'D MANAGED TO UNLEARN** (6)

Mitades: before he could | unlearn

Por qué: Unlearn: desaprender, quitarse un hábito, una técnica o una idea aprendida. It took me years to pasa a it was years before + oración, y para no cambiar unlearn hace falta un modal (could, managed to, was able to), que además recoge el esfuerzo.

No puntúa: *BEFORE HE UNLEARNT (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; para mantener unlearn hace falta could o managed to); *FOR HIM TO UNLEARN (it was years no admite for + infinitivo: pide before + oración).

Teoría: §16 Trabajo, esfuerzo y dinero

30 RANKLES WITH MANY VILLAGERS THAT (5 palabras)

También vale: RANKLES [WITH] (MANY / A LOT OF / LOTS OF / MANY OF THE / A GREAT MANY) (VILLAGERS / LOCALS / RESIDENTS) THAT (4–7) · **RANKLES [WITH] MANY PEOPLE IN THE VILLAGE THAT** (7–8)

Mitades: rankles with | many villagers that

Por qué: It rankles (with sb) that…: escuece, sigue doliendo con el tiempo; still encaja con esa persistencia. En británico lleva with; el uso transitivo (it rankles many villagers) también se acepta.

No puntúa: *RANKLES TO MANY VILLAGERS THAT (la preposición es with); *RANKLED WITH MANY VILLAGERS THAT (no usa la palabra clave tal cual: el ítem vale 0; still y el presente de la frase 1 piden rankles).

Teoría: §15 Emociones, relaciones y trato